2013 Kia Rio LX

$4,500 · 152,000 miles · Private seller · Lancaster, CA

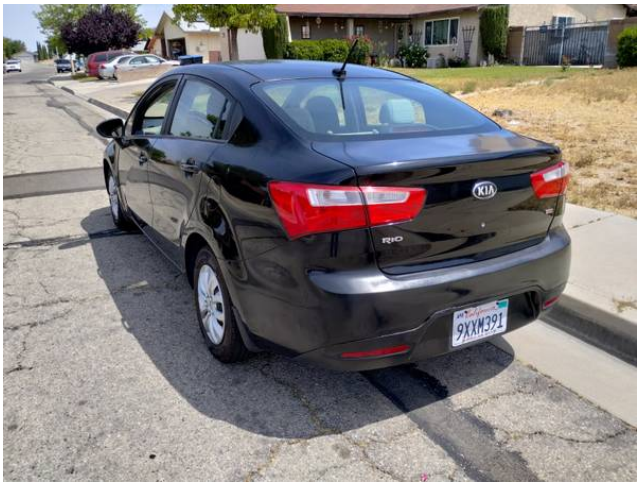
Seller: Private seller

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/lancaster-2013-kia-rio-lx-dependable/q2mR24cik3nAuNK9G32E9a

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder



+ 5 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$5,100	**$455**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 1 recalls · 153 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$4,500.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$416.25
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$29.25
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$5,100.50
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$100.50
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$2.01
Total interest over the loan	$20.33
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$2.01
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 31 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$153.23
Maintenance & repair reserve	$150.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$14.94
Total per month	$455.18

Running costs without the loan: **$453/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$10,695** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

The 2012-17 Rio (1.6L GDI, 6-speed automatic) is an average-to-good small car: simple, cheap parts, not part of the Hyundai/Kia Theta II engine recalls. High miles mean maintenance history matters.

NHTSA data for this model year: 1 recalls · 153 owner complaints (8 involving a crash). Most complaints: Engine (53), Air Bags (34), Service Brakes (30), Electrical System (27), Hydraulic (21), Unknown Or Other (19).

Known issues for this model

• Carbon buildup on direct-injected 1.6L (rough idle, misfires at high miles)

• Oil consumption if oil changes were stretched

• Brake light switch (recall)

• A/C condenser / compressor wear

Check on this car before buying

• Smooth idle, no check-engine light (scan for stored codes)

• Oil level and color

• Run VIN for open recalls

• A/C cold

• Shifts smoothly 1-6 with no flare

Notes

$4,500, 152k mi, automatic sedan, black. Clean title IN THE SELLER'S NAME, tags good until April 2027. New tires, new catalytic converter (has receipt), 'no leaks, no mechanical issues', minor door dings. Posted 2026-09-24, renewed 2026-10-10.

Text only (number in the ad), Mon-Fri 10am-6:30pm. ~1.5 hr drive from Ridgecrest - confirm before going.

2026-10-25: LISTING DELETED on Craigslist (the ad said it would come down when sold) - likely sold.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.